

Newsletter, March 2026



SORTEE

Society for Open, Reliable, and Transparent
Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

Website: <https://www.sortee.org/>

Instagram: www.instagram.com/sortecoevo/

Twitter/X: [@sortecoevo](https://twitter.com/sortecoevo)

Bluesky: <https://bsky.app/profile/sortee.bsky.social>

LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/company/sortee/

Slack: <https://sortee.slack.com/>

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Updates to SORTEE membership

Dear SORTEE members,

We recently moved from fixed annual memberships to a **rolling membership model**, meaning your membership is now valid for one full year from the date you sign up. Previously, all memberships expired at the end of the calendar year, even if you joined late in the year. This meant new members sometimes only received a few months of membership benefits. With the new rolling membership model, each membership now lasts a full year from the date you sign up.

We are also excited to share that SORTEE now offers a **3-year membership option!**

Following a suggestion from our Senior Advisory Board (and inspired by other societies), we're now introducing discounted **3-year memberships**:

- **Senior members (3 years): \$110**
- **Early career members (3 years): \$50**
- **Student members (3 years): \$25**

We hope this option provides convenience, stability, and long-term support for SORTEE members and our mission to advance open, reliable, and transparent ecology and evolutionary biology.

Thank you for being part of our growing community,
SORTEE Leadership

SORTEE Conference 2026 - save the date

The sixth annual [SORTEE Conference](#) will be held virtually in October 2026 (continuously for a little over 24 hours from October 13th to October 14th, to cover all timezones). The conference will be **FREE** for SORTEE members, and ranging from \$0 to \$60 for non-SORTEE members.

The conference is a forum to **discuss** and **develop ideas**, while also exploring **current practices** for advancing research in fields related to open science in ecology and evolutionary biology.

The conference will be a mix of 5 session types:

- **Unconferences:** Facilitated discussions of ideas for how to make ecology, evolutionary biology, and related disciplines more open, reliable, and transparent.
- **Hackathons:** Group projects with well-defined goals (papers, techniques, software, protocols, organizations, etc.).
- **Workshops:** Facilitators will teach tools to implement open, reliable, and transparent practices.
- **Plenaries:** Two plenaries about recent initiatives in open science.
- **Introductions to open science:** Two sessions dedicated to people new to open science.

To have an idea of what a SORTEE conference looks like, check out the 2025 SORTEE conference program [here](#) and the summary of previous conferences at <https://www.sortee.org/past>.

Content submissions will soon open on [this page](#)

To have a great conference, we need motivating events and keen facilitators! We invite anyone interested in facilitating an unconference, a hackathon or a workshop to submit their content. You don't have to be a SORTEE member.

To join the mailing list and receive conference updates, click [here](#).

We are trying our best to make this conference as inclusive as possible. We encourage individuals with questions regarding accessibility when facilitating a session or attending the conference to reach out to us at conference@sortee.org.

The SORTEE Guidelines for Data and Code Quality Control in Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

It has become increasingly clear that deposited/archived data and code are often not sufficient to reproduce published results, due either to low rates of archiving or to low quality of archived data and code. To address this, several ecology and evolutionary biology journals have recruited data editors. The role of these editors is to assess the

quality of archived data and code and whether it meets certain standards needed for high reproducibility, a process we refer to as data and code quality control.

After a panel discussion with data editors in January 2024, organised by the Education and Outreach committee as part of the SORTEE webinar series, it became evident to members of the advocacy committee that there were no clear guidelines for what a data editor should assess, and that practice varied greatly across data editors, both among and within journals. Starting with extensive consultation with multiple data editors for several different journals across ecology and evolution (American Naturalist, Proceedings of the Royal Society B, Ecology Letters, Behavioural Ecology and Sociobiology, Peer Community In, and the Journal of Evolutionary Biology), the advocacy committee put together a set of detailed guidelines with the aim of standardising the practice of data and code quality control across ecology and evolutionary biology journals.

We are now pleased to announce [the publication of these guidelines](#) in the Peer Community Journal, after a fantastic [open review process](#) at Peer Community In Ecology. These published guidelines were the result of long discussions and the engagement of many dedicated data editors. We hope that these guidelines provide a consistent and standardised set of review stages for journals and data editors to follow when they check the data and code associated with a manuscript. This will also enable readers and authors to better understand what checks have been performed, particularly if these are made clear by the journal.

[The guidelines](#) cover many different checks, from the presence of data to assessing full computational reproducibility (the reported results can be recreated with the provided data and code). We recognise that the capacity for different journals to assess these components, as well as their motivations for doing so, will vary widely, and so we have broken the guidelines into 6 stages, which journals can choose to adopt in a stepwise manner. Stages 1-2 (checking the quality of archived data and metadata, and that it matches what is reported in the manuscript) allow for data re-use, stages 3-4 (checking the quality of archived code and metadata, and that it matches what is reported in the manuscript) promote increased transparency, and stages 5-6 (check the code runs and reproduces reported results) enable full

computational reproducibility to be assessed. Journals can therefore increase the transparency of the data and code quality control process by clearly stating what stages are routinely checked by their data editors.

Aside from providing a standardised and detailed template for existing data editors, [these guidelines](#) provide a valuable resource for other journals, which we hope will prompt them to consider recruiting data editors to increase the quality of shared data and code across ecology and evolution and more broadly. If you know any journal editors, please reach out to them and let them know about these guidelines!

March SORTEE Code Club session

20.03.2026 (20 March, 2026)

15:00 - 16:00 UTC

Join us for another session all about Git! Last year we hosted a training session about Git: <https://cecibaldoni.quarto.pub/version-control/#/title-slide>. This year we will be providing a more hands-on session where we will show you some tips and tricks when using Git and Github. If you have no background using Git but want to follow along, here is a nice Git tutorial to get you started: <https://lmu-osc.github.io/Introduction-RStudio-Git-GitHub/>. Hope to see you there!

Code club zoom link:

https://us06web.zoom.us/join/84007888145?signature=yDWKbuCysjDZ-Ld3K7DRllcJf0wKpf8_nnt-juIwgRs

Updating SORTEE collaborations webpage

The Member Engagement committee is keen to update SORTEE's webpage about our collaborative projects: <https://sortee.org/collaborations/> If you have any suggestions of past, ongoing, or future SORTEE projects and outcomes (not just research papers but also other stuff we do together!) - please let Losia know either via Slack messages or email (losialaghisz@gmail.com). Thanks and looking forward to hearing from you about your collaborations with other lovely SORTEE people!

Virtual Socials in 2026

This year's monthly Virtual Socials will be all about meeting SORTEE's committees! Join us for a relaxed and informal 30-min break to meet the different committees and ask them anything: about what they do, what their plans for the year are, whatever you can think of! In March, you'll get the chance to meet the Member Engagement committee and the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion committee. Date and time will be announced soon via Slack and by Calendar invite (see below).

Sign up for SORTEE Calendar Invites

Don't miss out on all the great upcoming events to learn and connect with other SORTEE members in 2026. Sign up to receive calendar invites about SORTEE events in your local time zone using [this google form](#).

Call to join and start local chapters

If you are missing more Open Science engagement in your community, and are interested in starting a local chapter for your region, please join us in [the #local-chapters channel](#)! We are a small community (but growing), with a Local Chapter for Brasil and a new Local Chapter starting in Canada (find more info [here](#)). The new Slack channel will be a place for us to find community, as we help each other to make this grass-roots movement really create some roots. If you are not sure how to start, you're not alone. You can have a glimpse of Rachel Turba's struggles starting up the Brasil Local Chapter [in this blogpost](#). We also have Rounak Choudhary interested in gathering people from India, so if you are from or are based in India, please reach out to them at: rounakchoudhary17@gmail.com

First 'ECR Asks' interview of 2026

We spoke with Alex Holcombe about understanding publishing costs and the future of community-led publication. Read more on the SORTEE blog:

https://sortee.org/blog/2026/03/03/2026_ecr_asks_alex_holcombe/



SORTEE supporters in 2026

Several organizations have renewed their support for SORTEE in 2026: [Dryad](#), Peer Community In ([PCI](#)), the [Royal Society](#), and the Society for the Study of Evolution ([SSE](#)). Their generous support helps sustain SORTEE's core activities and services, including our annual conference, Workshop & Webinar Series, official preprint server ([EcoEvoRxiv](#)), and meet-ups at in-person conferences. Please reach out to the chair of the Fundraising Committee, Ruby Krasnow (ruby.krasnow@maine.edu), if you or any organization you know would be open to supporting SORTEE!

EcoEvoRxiv in 2026

Early March marked a special milestone for EcoEvoRxiv: we reached 3000 preprints! The volume of submissions increased throughout the better part of last year and with no signs of slowing down, we might be celebrating another milestone later this year. To handle and screen these submissions, the EcoEvoRxiv Committee grew substantially at the start of the year. All 9 new editors finished their onboarding and are ready to join the other 9 long-serving editors in moderating the preprint server.

A side effect of the increase in submissions is a larger number of preprints that are likely partly or fully written using generative AI. To get a better grip on this, the EcoEvoRxiv Committee is setting up two working groups. One working group will work on refining the server's policy and submission guidelines, so that it becomes clearer for authors what is expected of them and their preprints as well as easier for editors handling incoming preprints. A second working group will focus on creating an easy-to-use, practical document guiding authors on the use of generative AI.

Other plans for 2026 include the expansion of training videos and other materials on the EcoEvoRxiv website, and exploring collaborations with other preprint servers or partnerships with journals. Behind the scenes, we continue checking in with California Digital Library, the hosts of the EcoEvoRxiv server, and the developers of Janeway, the preprint platform, to improve the user experience of the submission system for authors and moderation system for editors.

Nominations for the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Awards will open on April 1

The Awards Committee is happy to announce that nominations for the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Awards will open on April 1!

The Commendation Award recognizes projects that align with SORTEE's aims and values by fostering Open Science practices in ecology and evolutionary biology. A

project can include, but is not limited to, initiatives such as journal clubs, workshops, seminar series, websites, repositories, tools, educational materials, public talks, podcasts, and more. Projects may be local or global in scope, and both team-based and individual initiatives are welcome.

This year, the Awards Committee is introducing a protocol for assessing the eligibility of nominations, which we hope will help make our process more transparent and accessible to everyone.

Nominations will be open until 31 August 2026. Eligible projects will be assessed by the Awards Committee and approved by the Board of Directors, with winners announced at the SORTEE Virtual Conference in October.

If you have a project that fosters Open Science practices in ecology and evolutionary biology, or if you know someone whose work would be a great fit, we encourage you to submit a nomination.

Learn more about eligibility and submit a nomination: <https://sortee.org/awards/>.

Add links to sortee.org on your website

If you have a website, please consider adding a link to sortee.org. The more websites that link to sortee.org, the higher our search engine rankings will be. This will help people searching on Google or other search engines find us more readily. Thanks!

Submit to the SORTEE Newsletter

We welcome submissions to our newsletter. If you know of anything that SORTEE should or could announce (events, publications, announcements, ideas) in our newsletter, please let us know by sending an email to the newsletter editor, Tim Parker parkerth@whitman.edu with "SORTEE Newsletter" in the header (We do not advertise commercial services or products)

2026 SORTEE leadership team

Marija Purgar (Board Member, President, Awards Committee Chair)

Malgorzata (Losia) Lagisz (Board Member, President-elect)

Matthieu Paquet (Board Member, Secretary)

Ed Ivimey-Cook (Past-President, Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Christian John (Treasurer)

Michael Bertram (Board Member)

Stephanie Flaman (Board Member, Conference Committee Chair)

Juliette Tariel-Adam (Board Member)

Ineta Kacergytė (Board Member)

Aidan Tan (Board Member)

Joel Pick (Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Brooke Long-Fox (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Mark Young (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Stefan Vriend (EcoEvoRxiv Committee Chair)

Saoirse Kelleher (Education and Outreach Committee Chair)

Ruby Krasnow (Fundraising Committee Chair)

Oakleigh Wilson (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Swastika Issar (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Natalie van Dis (Member Engagement Committee Chair)